```
$ brew search php
==> Formulae
brew-php-switcher    php@8.1        phpmd
php                  php@8.2        phpmyadmin
php-code-sniffer     php@8.3        phpstan
php-cs-fixer         phpbrew        phpunit
php-cs-fixer@2       phpmd          ...
```

We can see there's `php` (latest version, 8.4 at the time of writing), then older versions with a `@` symbol in their names: `php@8.1`, `php@8.2` and so on. Let's install latest `php`:

```
$ brew install php
$ php -v
PHP 8.4.5 (cli) (built: Mar 12 2025 01:55:56) (NTS)
```

Just for fun, let's install PHP 8.1:

```
$ brew install php@8.1
$ php -v
PHP 8.2.10 (cli) (built: Aug 31 2023 19:16:09) (NTS)
```

As you can see, we still have the same version switching problem to overcome, which we'll get to shortly. Before that, here's what happens when we try to install PHP 7.4

```
$ brew install php@7.4
Error: php@7.4 has been disabled because it is a versioned formula!
```

Sooner or later, with Homebrew, you'll run into this problem. The package is still available, but the formula has an expiry date (feels appropriate for a beer-themed package manager). The solution, once again, is to add a third-party repository. In Homebrew parlance a repository is a *tap*, which maps a remote git repository to a local filesystem path. We'll use the `shivammathur/php` git repo.

```
$ brew tap shivammathur/php
==> Tapping shivammathur/php
Cloning into '/usr/local/Homebrew/Library/Taps/shivammathur/
homebrew-php'...

$ brew install shivammathur/php/php@7.4
```